

GLOSSARY

Accelerate

To speed up and go faster.

Aerobatics

Acrobatics in the air, performed by aircraft for entertainment as well as in competitions.

Ailerons

Hinged surfaces, usually on an aircraft's wing, that can be raised or lowered to help an aircraft roll or turn.

Alloy

A mixture of two or more elements, at least one of which is a metal. Alloys often have useful properties that differ from those of the elements from which they are made.

Amphibious

A vehicle that can travel both on land and in water.

Articulated train

A train with cars linked together by a single, pivoting joint.

Autogiro

An aircraft with both a main rotor, for lift, and a propeller, to give forward thrust.

Battery

A store of chemicals in a case that, when connected to a circuit, supplies electricity.

Boiler

The part of a steam engine in which steam is produced.

Bow

The forward part of a vessel.

Bowsprit

A spar (pole) that extends forward from a ship's bow.

Bridge

The part of a ship from where the captain controls the vessel.

Buffer

A shock-absorbing pad that cushions the impact of rail vehicles as they come together.

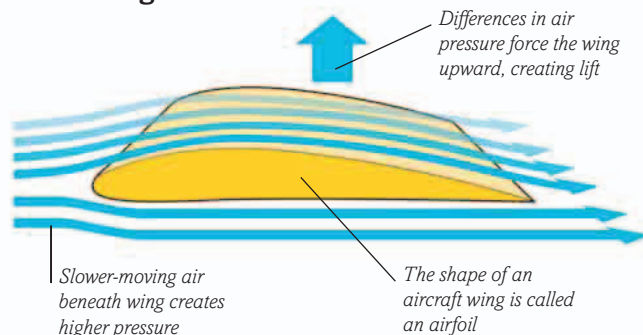
Bumper

A metal, rubber, or plastic bar fitted along the front and, sometimes, the back of a vehicle to limit damage if it bumps into something.

Cab

The part of a train or truck

How wings work



Lift

As the curved wing moves through the air, the air passing over the wing moves faster than the air passing beneath. Fast-moving air has a lower pressure. It is the slower, high-pressure air beneath the wing that forces it upward.

where the driver sits and controls the vehicle.

Class

A group of locomotives built to a common design.

Convoy

A group of ships or vehicles travelling in formation.

Coupling

The parts, or mechanism, that allow railroad locomotives to be joined together.

Derailleur

The part of a bike that moves the bicycle chain from one gear wheel to another when the rider changes gear.

Destroyer

A small, fast warship armed with guns, torpedoes, or guided missiles.

Diesel

A type of fuel made from oil used in many vehicle engines.

Disk brakes

A type of brake that uses pads to press against a turning disk, creating friction to slow the vehicle down.

Drag

A force of resistance on a vehicle as it moves through air or water, slowing it down.

Drone

Also known as an Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV), a flying machine that either controls itself or is controlled remotely by a human operator.

Electromagnets

Magnets that are powered by electricity and can be switched on or off.

Elevator

A control surface on an aircraft that causes the plane to raise or lower its nose and climb or dive.

Excavator

A vehicle used at building sites to dig holes using a

